

AICloudStrategist

Credibility Badges + Remote Communities

Purpose: Two compounding assets that build trust without requiring in-person presence.

1. **Free credibility badges** – public-facing memberships and partnerships that go on our site and in email signatures
2. **Remote communities** – places Anushka can publicly contribute as a way to build reputation without leaving Delhi

Section 1 – AWS Partner Network (Registered tier is FREE, apply today)

What it is

The AWS Partner Network has 4 tiers: Registered → Select → Advanced → Premier. The first tier (Registered) is free to join and requires NO certifications or existing customers. You just fill a form, AWS verifies the business, and you can:

- Use “AWS Registered Partner” language on the site
- Display the (small) AWS Partner logo in footer/about
- Access some AWS Partner Central resources
- Get listed in the AWS Partner Solutions Finder (low-traffic but it exists)

How to apply (Registered tier, ~30 minutes)

Prerequisites: - AWS account in good standing (we don't have one yet – create one on Rajiv's business email) - Business entity (AICloudStrategist – Anushka's sole proprietorship or Rajiv's entity, whichever is the legal owner) - Business website (aicloudstrategist.com – already live) - Business address (Rohini, Delhi 110085 – already on site)

Steps: 1. Create AWS account at <https://aws.amazon.com/> (if not already) 2. Go to AWS Partner Central: <https://aws.amazon.com/partners/> 3. Click “Join the AWS Partner Network” 4. Fill business registration form: - Legal entity name - Business address - Website URL - Primary contact (Anushka as Founder) - Business focus: Services - Partner path: Services (consulting) 5. Submit and wait 5-10 business days for approval email 6. On approval: download logo kit, add to footer of aicloudstrategist.com

What this gets us

- **Credibility signal** in every cold email signature: “AWS Partner Network – Registered”
- **Logo placement** on /services.html and /proof.html (small, bottom)
- **Listed in AWS's own directory** – low-volume inbound but real
- **Future path** to Select tier once we have 3 customers + 2 AWS certifications

Future path (post-first-customer)

Once we have 3 engagements delivered: - Earn 2 AWS certifications (Foundational + Technical) – Anushka takes them online, free study material, ~\$100 exam fee each - Apply for **Select tier**: 4 accredited individuals (can combine contractors), \$1500+ MRR from AWS opportunities (the 3 customers we signed) - Select tier gives: bigger logo, listed higher in directory, AWS sales co-sell potential, partner-only events (virtual)

Timeline: Registered tier achievable by Day 10 of sprint. Select tier achievable by Month 3.

Section 2 – FinOps Foundation membership (FREE community tier)

What it is

[FinOps Foundation](#) is the industry body for FinOps. Has a community Slack with ~10K members globally, India cohort is ~200-300.

How to join (10 minutes, free)

1. Go to <https://www.finops.org/community/community-slack/>

2. Fill membership form (name, company, email)
3. Auto-approved for community access in 24-48 hours
4. Accept Slack invite via email

How to use it

- **Observer mode first** (week 1): Read the channels. Note which ones are active. Understand who the heavy contributors are.
- **Helper mode** (week 2-3): Answer 2-3 technical questions per week in the #general or regional channels. Indian-specific context is a differentiator here – most members are US/EU.
- **Contributor mode** (month 2+): Propose a case study write-up for the FinOps Foundation's publications. Gets you and the company name in FinOps-adjacent circulation.

Why it's worth the time

- Name recognition inside the FinOps community compounds over 6-12 months
- Members ARE the buyers – they're finops practitioners inside mid-to-large companies
- FinOps Foundation practitioner certification is the #1 credential in this space; membership is the on-ramp

Section 3 – AWS User Group Delhi + Bangalore (virtual participation)

What they are

AWS User Groups are volunteer-run meetups in every major Indian city. Most have an active Slack or Meetup group plus monthly events (some virtual, some hybrid).

Most relevant ones for us

- **AWS User Group Delhi** – our home city, biggest in-person access later
 - Meetup: <https://www.meetup.com/aws-user-group-delhi/>
 - Slack: invite via Meetup organizers
- **AWS User Group Bengaluru** – largest in India, all-virtual channels active
 - Meetup: <https://www.meetup.com/awsugblr/>
- **AWS User Group Mumbai**
 - Meetup: <https://www.meetup.com/awsugmum/>
- **AWS Community Builders India** – curated, application-based (worth applying even if rejected first time)
 - Apply: <https://aws.amazon.com/developer/community/community-builders/>

Playbook for remote participation

- Join the Meetup + any associated Slack
- Attend the next virtual event (usually free, 1 hour evening IST)
- Comment / ask one thoughtful question in the session chat
- After 2 events, DM an organizer offering to give a 15-minute talk on "Indian FinOps patterns" (we have 11 blog posts we can adapt)
- Getting on the speaker roster = huge credibility signal. AWS User Group Delhi has 1-2 talks per event, 3-5 events per year. One slot per year is realistic.

Success criteria

- Joined all 3 by end of Week 1
- Active in chat at 1 event by end of Week 2
- Pitched a talk by end of Month 1

Section 4 – FinOps Connect + other global FinOps events

FinOps X 2026 (virtual attendance possible)

[FinOps X 2026](#) – the FinOps Foundation’s flagship annual conference. June 2026 in-person (San Diego) but with virtual attendance option.

- Virtual ticket ~\$199-299 (worth it if we’ve signed 1-2 deals by then)
- Watch all the talks live
- Network in the conference Slack during event
- Cite talks on our blog (shows we’re engaged with the community)

FinOps Connect (free, ongoing)

[FinOps Connect](#) – quarterly-ish virtual gatherings. Free. Small audience (~200-500) but high-quality attendees.

- Next one: Check the site for current schedule
- Register free
- Attend, ask a question, DM a few attendees afterwards

Section 5 – Indie Hackers + Hacker News + Reddit (engagement, not just posting)

Indie Hackers

Create Anushka’s Indie Hackers profile at <https://www.indiehackers.com/>

Profile should say: > Founder, AICloudStrategist. Cloud cost consultancy for Indian mid-market. Founder-led. Enterprise-reviewed. Writes at aicloudstrategist.com/blog.

Then: post 1 long-form piece per month. Comment on 5 other posts per week. Indie Hackers rewards consistency.

Hacker News

Rajiv’s existing HN account (needs to be 90+ days old with some activity) can submit blog posts to Show HN or the standard submission flow.

Don’t submit until a post has already proven to land on Reddit (>500 upvotes). HN is bigger audience but harder to land – use it second.

r/IndianStartups + r/startups

Different from r/startups_india (which is more founder-friendly). r/IndianStartups is smaller but has fewer moderators filtering business posts. r/startups is US-leaning but huge.

Don’t post on r/startups until we have an actual customer case study. “I’m building X in India” posts die instantly there.

Section 6 – Delhi-specific assets

TiE Delhi-NCR

[TiE Delhi-NCR](#) is the local chapter of TiE (The Indus Entrepreneurs). Entrepreneurs’ network. Membership 20K/year, includes events + mentor access.

Don’t join yet – 20K is real money. Re-evaluate at Month 3 when we have revenue. Until then, attend FREE TiE events (open to non-members for select sessions).

Nasscom membership

Nasscom is the industry body for Indian IT services. Membership is expensive (1L+/year). **Not worth it for solo practice.** Might revisit at Month 12 if we scale to 5+ clients.

Delhi Design Forum, Google for Startups Accelerator

Google for Startups Accelerator: AI First (India) – <https://startup.google.com/programs/accelerator/ai-first/india/>. Free but application-only and competitive. Worth applying for month 6 after we have traction.

Tracker items to add

```
vk add 7 "Apply AWS Partner Network Registered (free, 30 min)" "https://aws.amazon.com/partners/ – approval 5-
days"
vk label <id> rajiv-owns
vk prio <id> 4
vk add 7 "Join FinOps Foundation community Slack (free)" "https://www.finops.org/community/community-slack/ –
observer mode week 1"
vk label <id> waiting-on-anushka
vk add 7 "Join AWS User Group Delhi Meetup" "https://www.meetup.com/aws-user-group-delhi/"
vk label <id> waiting-on-anushka
vk add 7 "Join AWS User Group Bengaluru (virtual)" "https://www.meetup.com/awsugblr/"
vk label <id> waiting-on-anushka
vk add 7 "Create Anushka Indie Hackers profile" "https://www.indiehackers.com/"
vk label <id> waiting-on-anushka
```

Expected impact

These are not lead-generation activities in the direct sense. They're **trust-compounding** activities that make every cold email, every DM, every blog post 2-3x more credible.

Month 1: No direct leads attributable, but "AWS Partner Network – Registered" badge appears on site and email signature. Conversion rate on cold email goes up.

Month 3: 1-2 opportunities traced back to FinOps Slack visibility or AWS User Group presence.

Month 6+: First talk at an AWS User Group or FinOps meetup → speaker-derived leads compound for 6-12 months after the talk.

All of this is free or very low cost. Total hard cost: maybe 25K/year if we eventually buy FinOps X virtual ticket + 2 AWS certifications for Select tier. Everything else is time.